

METRE, ETC.

THOMASON, in his introduction, has his firm conviction that Piobair and to-day there are few disposed might be urged that the music Thomason thought, otherwise he would be correct which contained more, or very clearly recognised to-day to be strictly metrical, and no player of with, say, seven or nine bars to a line, as well as enthusiasts, are prepared to see it in a mutilated state !

It is not sufficiently recognised how much is complete, in consequence of the remarks, otherwise we should not be prepared to see the versions collected by MacDonald and others with criticism. These remarks should in no way detract from the wonderful work of the early piobair, but they could of the ancient music. It is not accorded. The point must not be reached us in a mutilated state, and it is to be taken down from the last of the century, because, after all, Iain Dubh was a man of twenty tunes published, and it came down to him from his forebears in an unimpaired condition after the '45 clearly demonstrating

that the metrical mutilation, it should be noted that different schools or styles of play were followed by MacKay, Campbell, etc.—and tunes might have been differently recorded. Mr. Burne, Australia, states that his father recorded various tunes differently from Iain Dubh, and that at the time there were different methods ! Even allowing for

the 4.6.4. metre tunes were principles of construction referred to, it have appeared in 6.6.4. metre metre will probably be found, the with two missing bars in the first part of 3.4.3. as peculiar to the in "Ceol Mor" appear to be in strict 3, the "Lament for Lachlan M" by a 12.12.8 (or 6.6.4.) metre tune

TIME.

exist in the time in which tunes to appreciate the reason, when recorded is the player's expression, final measure. The nearer we get to recording tunes in staff notation, the construction and to correct errors of expression as primitive music, let us, then, classification! It will be found in *paireachd*—which might be described as "Three" time. "Even" time is made in *two* or *four* beats per bar and in *three* beats. Where "Even" time and its doubling should be divided according to modern standards, whereas it should be divided into *three* equal parts

the actual "time" to be used in two minims per bar is the most satisfactory. "Even" time tunes, although there are some in eight time. "Three" time tunes are three minims, or perhaps three crotchets. In the most satisfactory time with the joining together of each pair of minims.

In the case of the complicated tunes of minor importance, so long as some satisfaction of playing them is reached. It is

system for the publication of a tune, as it assists him to memorise it, and is identified with the corresponding Crunluth, being more clearly understood.

Matters also, method in studying the Crunluth. The keen student is anxious to know the name, or otherwise, of the Taorluth which is usually accompanied by a Crunluth. In the various published Collections of a *Taorluth* Fosgailte Variations, the Crunluth is often followed by a Taorluth. Where, however, a Crunluth is invariably accompanied by a Taorluth, it is not so. In the few cases where a Crunluth is accompanied by a similar Taorluth, it is not so. The inference is, that the Crunluth is the other form of 'Fosgailte' where the other form of 'Fosgailte' has crept into the Crunluth. As many variations as possible, such as those of MacDonald and Angus MacKintosh, the existence of the Fosgailte Taorluth is not to be taken for granted. The tunes (tunes with three beats per bar) are foreign and cannot belong to the Crunluth. The modern tunes which are not accompanied by a corresponding Fosgailte Crunluth, may be that the inclusion of such a Crunluth was intentional, but this goes to the Crunluth instruction has been lost!

Matters careful *methodical* study will be to the casual student.